

MCP 101 · PART 1 · GET IT

MCP in *plain English*

MCP is one of the most common words thrown around in GTM right now. Yet, it is rarely explained in simple terms. This is the starting point: understand it first, then trust it, use it and stretch it.

MCP (Model Context Protocol) is a standard that lets AI clients like Claude or ChatGPT connect to tools and use them *without every integration being built from scratch.*

BEFORE MCP

9 BUILDS

	CRM	Email	Calls
Claude			
ChatGPT			
Copilot			

Every tool needed a custom integration for every AI client.

NOW

1 BUILD

Claude

ChatGPT

Copilot



One Backstory MCP server

One MCP server → multiple AI clients can use the tool.

If MCP still feels abstract, *start here.*

ANALOGY 1

The filing cabinet

Backstory	is the filing cabinet.
Claude	is the analyst.
MCP	is the badge that opens specific drawers.
Each tool	is one drawer.

ANALOGY 2

The standard plug

One standard plug. *Every appliance.*
Every wall.

Before, every device needed its own custom connection to your wall. The standard plug → any appliance works.



Your deal context, *wherever you work.*

01

Context where you work

Ask your AI tool about an account and get answers from Backstory, without switching tabs.

02

Connect once

One server works across the AI clients your team already uses, so no one waits on a custom build.

03

Answers stay grounded

Your AI tool works from summaries of the emails, meetings and CRM activity Backstory captures.

TRY ASKING

“Catch me up on Halden Freight.”

“Any risks on the Halden Freight renewal deal?”



Two things worth remembering

WORTH KNOWING

MCP is an open standard. Anthropic released it in November 2024, and OpenAI, Google and Microsoft have since added support.

DID YOU KNOW?

An AI client can only use the tools an MCP server chooses to expose. It sees the drawers it has been given, not the whole cabinet.

A standard way for AI tools to connect *directly* to Backstory data

01 · THE PROTOCOL

One standard, any client

Claude, Copilot and a growing list of AI clients speak MCP. Backstory exposes one server; you connect whichever AI tool your team already lives in.

02 · THE BRIDGE

Current data, real permissions

Answers are up to date with what Backstory has captured. Each person sees what their Backstory user sees.

03 · THE DIFFERENCE

No copy, paste and hope

Instead of pasting a summary into a chat window and hoping it's current, your AI tool pulls Backstory's summaries itself.

“What deals does my team have closing this quarter?” Asked in Claude, answered from Backstory.

Similar deals

WHAT IT DOES

Finds similar deals at other customers. You may get a different set each time.

MCP ONLY

Not exposed anywhere else in Backstory. Matches can include open deals, so treat them as examples.

IN PILOT

Available to pilot customers now. Still being tuned for the right level of granularity.

WHY IT MATTERS FOR GTM

Reps get comparable deals to learn from. Managers can coach from real examples instead of memory.

Have we had a deal like the Halden Freight renewal before? How'd it go?

 Loaded tools, used Backstory MCP integration >

I found similar deals at other customers. Here's the closest match and what stood out. Two other matches are still open.

Closest match: a renewal at a mid-market logistics company

Similar shape: a multi-year renewal, a new budget owner, and pricing that needed rework before signature.

What stood out

- Separated subscription pricing from services pricing, which cleared up buyer confusion
- Ran a technical alignment session so stakeholders had what they needed for sign-off
- Sent the order form the moment approvals cleared

ILLUSTRATIVE EXAMPLE · MOCK DATA

Your AI tool becomes an expert on *your* business

BEFORE MCP

- ✗ Copy account data out of Backstory, paste it into a chat, get generic advice
- ✗ Ask vague questions with no context behind them
- ✗ Switch between tools all day
- ✗ Analyze and report on data by hand

WITH MCP

- Your AI tool pulls summaries of your accounts and deals from the last 30 days
- Ask specific questions: "What are the risks on the Halden Freight deal?"
- Get insights based on your actual data, not generic best practices
- Work faster without leaving the assistant



Three kinds of *questions*

You never pick a tool. Claude does. What matters is which kind of question you ask and where each one stops.

01

One account or deal

“Catch me up on Halden Freight.”

REP, AM/GSM

“Any risks on the Halden Freight renewal deal?”

REP, MANAGER

Good to know: Covers the last 30 days. Use the full company name and check it in the first answer.

02

A list

“Using Backstory, what deals do I have closing this quarter?”

REP

“Which of my team’s deals closing this quarter have engagement under 50?”

MANAGER, VP

Good to know: Backstory says how it read the question. Check it says *your* deals and the right window.

03

Backstory’s assistant

“Ask Backstory’s assistant what the big themes have been with Halden Freight over the last 90 days.”

VP

Good to know: Start with “Ask Backstory’s assistant” for anything older than 30 days. It is most reliable for the last 30 days.



What MCP does, and what it doesn't

WHAT MCP DOES

- ✓ Gives AI tools your specific business context
- ✓ Returns faster, more relevant answers
- ✓ Cuts manual data gathering and analysis
- ✓ Grounds insights in your actual data

WHAT IT DOESN'T DO

- ✗ Replace human judgment or relationships
- ✗ Change anything in Backstory or your CRM. It only reads.
- ✗ Work well if Backstory data isn't up to date
- ✗ Replace a good sales process

Connect the AI tool your team already uses

SETUP GUIDES IN THE HELP CENTER

[Claude](#)[ChatGPT](#)[Microsoft Copilot](#)[Google Gemini](#)[n8n](#)

Backstory keeps adding support for more AI tools. Check the Help Center for the latest list.

QUICK ANSWERS

Do we need to change how we work?

No. Keep using Backstory as you do today. MCP gives your AI tools access to that data.

What does it cost?

MCP is included with your Backstory subscription. The AI tools themselves may have their own cost.

Five steps to roll it out

01

Take stock

Which AI tools does your team already use?

02

Pick use cases

Which prompts would save the most time?

03

Connect

Work with Backstory to set up MCP.

04

Train

Show your team how to ask better questions.

05

Measure

Track time saved and answer quality.

UP NEXT • GET IT

The first *15 minutes*

